

Agroverse Cacao Club

A Scarcity-Based Membership Model for Regenerative Ceremonial Cacao

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Executive Summary

Agroverse sells limited-vintage, single-farm ceremonial cacao — a genuinely scarce product — through an open e-commerce store as if it were an infinite commodity. This proposal flips the model: use scarcity as the marketing engine, not the bottleneck.

The Cacao Club replaces first-come-first-sold retail with a curated membership allocation. It is inspired by:

- **K&L Wine Merchants** (Jerry's wine subscription) — curated catalog with named buyers, club-vs-retail pricing, deep origin storytelling
- **Futo Estate** — ultra-exclusive allocation model where demand exceeds supply by design
- **Ander Cacao** — barista-grade product design and embedding into the specialty coffee ecosystem

The Core Problem

Current Model	Problem
Open shop to everyone	First-come-first-sold; loyal customers miss out
Single price point (\$25)	No tiering; leaves money on the table
No recurring revenue	Every sale is a one-off; no predictability
Product-first messaging	Missing the barista/cafe workflow language
No membership structure	No reason to return beyond need

The Opportunity

Agroverse already has what these reference models envy:

1. **Per-bag QR traceability** — deeper than anything K&L or Futo offers
2. **Real regenerative impact** — 10,000 hectares of Amazon rainforest restoration
3. **Multiple single-farm origins** — Oscar, La do Sitio, Jesus Do Deus, Fazenda Santa Ana
4. **Farm videos and farmer stories** — authentic, not manufactured
5. **Genuinely limited vintage inventory** — each harvest is finite

The limitation is not the product. It is the *model*.

Proposed Membership Structure

Tier 1 — Barista Partner (Wholesale, invite-only)

Target: Specialty coffee shops, cafes, roasters

Price: Wholesale pricing (approx 40-50% below retail)

Inventory access: First allocation of each new vintage

Experience:

- 20-second steam wand format (new product needed)
- Brew guides for cafe equipment
- Farm video QR cards for menu placement
- Named account manager (like K&L's "by Rachael Ryan")

Annual cap: 20-30 partner cafes (scale with harvest volume)

Tier 2 — Cacao Club Member (Monthly/Quarterly subscription)

Target: Conscious consumers, home brewers, cacao enthusiasts

Price: \$24/month (quarterly shipment) — Club pricing vs \$30+ retail

What you get:

- Curated quarterly shipment — pre-selected single-farm ceremonial cacao
- Printed origin card with farm story (like K&L catalog, one paragraph per origin)
- QR code linking to farm video
- Member-only access to limited "Reserve" releases
- First refusal on next vintage before public

Inventory allocation: 40-50% of each harvest reserved for members

Target: 100 members in year one

Tier 3 — Patron (Annual, limited to 25)

Target: High-net-worth individuals, impact investors, brand champions

Price: \$500/year

What you get:

- All Cacao Club benefits
- Quarterly virtual farm call with the farmer
- Name on a tree-planting certificate (trees planted in their name)
- First access to all limited releases

Agroverse Cacao Club — Membership Model Proposal

- Hand-signed farmer letter with each shipment
- Exclusive "Reserve" single-harvest cacao at no extra cost

Inventory allocation: 10% of each harvest

Cap: 25 patrons — creates Futo-level exclusivity

Why Scarcity Works for Cacao

Cacao has a natural scarcity that wine and coffee also share — but Agroverse isn't using it yet:

Factor	Wine (Futo/K&L)	Coffee (Ander/third wave)	Cacao (Agroverse now)	Cacao (Agroverse proposed)
Vintage variation	Yes — celebrated	Yes — single origin	Yes — but not marketed	Yes — lead with it
Limited harvest	Yes — allocation model	Yes — limited lots	Yes — but sold openly	Yes — allocate first
Terroir specificity	Yes — AVA, vineyard	Yes — farm, elevation	Yes — QR has it	Yes — tell the story
Aging potential	Yes — cellar for decades	Yes — green storage	Yes — ceremonial cacao ages	Yes — market "library" vintages

Every constraint Agroverse has is a feature other industries charge a premium for.

Pricing Model

Tier	Revenue/member/year	100 members	25 patrons	Total annual recurring
Barista Partner (20 cafes)	\$3,000 (est wholesale)	—	—	\$60,000
Cacao Club (100 members)	\$288	\$28,800	—	\$28,800
Patron (25)	\$500	—	\$12,500	\$12,500
Retail (remaining inventory)	Variable	—	—	~\$30,000
Total				~\$131,300

Compare to current: 2,500 bags × \$25 = \$62,500 (one-time, no recurring, no retention).

Catalog Style: The K&L Playbook Applied to Cacao

Jerry's K&L catalog taught us: the product description is the primary sales tool.

Current Agroverse product page (paraphrased):

> Ceremonial Cacao — Oscar's Farm, 2024. 200g. \$25.

Proposed Cacao Club catalog style:

> ### Oscar's Farm, 2024 Harvest

> **Ceremonial Cacao · 100% Criollo · Bahia, Brazil**

>

> *Selected for you by Ethan, your Cacao Buyer*

>

> From three generations of cacao wisdom on a century-old cabruca agroforest in Bahia's sunlit hillsides. These 80-year-old Criollo trees yield just 900kg per hectare — a deliberate restriction that concentrates flavor and honors the forest canopy above.

>

> Harvested by hand in July 2024. Fermented 5 days in cascading wooden boxes. Sun-dried on African beds. Light-roasted to preserve the bean's natural complexity.

>

> **Tasting notes:** Dried cherry, warm almond, subtle spice. Full-bodied with a smooth, ceremonial-grade melt.

>

> **QR code included** — scan to watch Oscar walk you through his farm.

>

> *Club: \$20.00 · Retail: \$25.00*

This single change — from a spec sheet to a story — is the highest-leverage transformation available.

Barista Channel: The Ander Playbook

Ander Cacao succeeds because they removed every barrier between a barista and serving quality cacao:

What Ander does that Agroverse should replicate:

1. **Barista-grade format** — ground chocolate that dissolves in 20 seconds on a steam wand
2. **Brew guides for cafe equipment** — V60, Clever Dripper, Hario Switch, Aeropress, French press, moka pot
3. **Origin naming like coffee** — "El Salvador Chiquihuat · complex & nutty" instead of just "ceremonial cacao"
4. **Trade show presence** — World of Coffee, SCA Expo
5. **Cafe collaborations** — partner with existing roasters who host tastings (like ANÄNA Coffee Roasters)

Recommended Agroverse actions:

- Develop a barista-grade ground format (finely milled for steam wand)
- Create "How to Brew" guides for cafe methods
- Build a B2B landing page with cafe language (not mission-first, but workflow-first)
- Send sample kits to 10 specialty coffee shops in target markets
- Attend World of Coffee or SCA Expo

Allocation Logic: The Futo Playbook

Futo Estate doesn't sell wine — they allocate access to wine. This creates:

1. **Demand that exceeds supply** — by design
2. **A waiting list** — people feel privileged to join
3. **No discounting** — members pay full price (or more) and thank you for it
4. **Collector mentality** — "I have an allocation from Oscar's 2024 single-farm harvest"

Agroverse application:

- Do not sell all inventory on the open store
- Reserve 50%+ for Cacao Club members
- Create a "Join the Waitlist" page, not a "Buy Now" page
- Release limited "Reserve" lots at premium pricing — "Only 50 bags available"
- Use Futo's line: *"Give me the choice between six bags with average access, and one bag with great access, and I'll choose great access every time."*

Implementation Roadmap

Phase 1 (Month 1-2)

- [] Close open subscription on agroverse.shop
- [] Launch "Join the Waitlist" landing page
- [] Draft Cacao Club catalog template (K&L style)
- [] Identify first 10 Barista Partner target cafes
- [] Develop barista-grade ground product spec

Phase 2 (Month 3-4)

- [] Open Cacao Club to 100 founding members (invite-only)
- [] Ship first quarterly allocation with origin cards + QR codes
- [] Onboard 5 Barista Partner cafes
- [] Launch brew guides page on agroverse.shop
- [] Send sample kits to 20 specialty coffee shops

Phase 3 (Month 5-6)

- [] Open Patron tier (cap 25)
- [] Host first virtual farm call with Oscar
- [] Release first limited "Reserve" lot to members only
- [] Evaluate barista channel — double down on what works
- [] Attend World of Coffee or SCA Expo

Metrics to Track

Metric	Target (Year 1)
Cacao Club members	100
Patrons	25
Barista Partners	20
Monthly recurring revenue	~\$5,000
Member retention rate	>80%
Average catalog read time	N/A (qualitative: do they read the stories?)
Inventory allocation efficiency	>90% (no unsold vintage)

Closing

Agroverse has the best raw materials in the ceremonial cacao space — regenerative farms, per-bag traceability, genuine relationships with farmers, and a mission that actually matters. What's missing is not product. It's the *container* — the membership model, the catalog storytelling, the barista workflow, and the scarcity narrative.

K&L (Jerry's subscription), Futo, and Ander each show a piece of the answer. This proposal integrates all three into a single, coherent model purpose-built for regenerative cacao.

The first step is simple: close the open shop, open a waitlist.

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